

May

3

2000

Geocaching games begin

US computer whizz Dave Ulmer hid a small container called a geocache in the woods by Beavercreek, Oregon, USA, kickstarting the pastime of geocaching. Players use satellite navigation and codes from the internet to locate hidden items.



Also on this day

1803 The USA nearly doubled in size with the Louisiana Purchase. French leader Napoleon Bonaparte sold the land to raise war funds.

1947 Japan's Constitution came into effect after World War II. It limited the emperor's power and banned the government from starting wars.

1978 The first spam email, which featured a computer advert, was sent to 400 users in the USA.

1979

Iron Lady

Margaret Thatcher was elected Britain's prime minister, making her the first woman to take the top job. The Iron Lady was the only 20th-century prime minister to win three consecutive terms in office.

1960



Musical sensation

A musical comedy about love and life, *The Fantasticks* opened in New York City, USA. With 17,162 performances in the following 42 years, this show would become the longest-running musical of all time.

Born this day

1933 James Brown, Black American singer and songwriter. Originally a gospel singer, he became a soul and funk star.

